

Microsoft Teams: your tool to increase employee engagement

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May 28, 2024

retention
community
interaction
awareness
participation
belonging
inclusion
satisfaction

Goal: increased engagement

- Increase awareness among staff about agency events, projects, activities
- Increase participation/interaction between staff
- Increase sense of belonging/community

Benefits

- It allows us to communicate more effectively on ESG topics.
- Staff feel more engaged.
- This can contribute to increased employee satisfaction and retention.
- Plus, we have another channel for communication (besides “asphyxiation by email”).

Examples of content

- National Pet Day
- Battle of the Memes
- Desert Island Dilemmas
- DEI content
- Awards/recognition (teams and individuals)
- Employee milestones, new employee announcements
- Agency videos

Industry-related events

 Britton, Chris (WaTech) 4/12 9:50 AM

WaTech connects with vets at VERG-JBLM job fair



WaTech recently attended the Veteran Employee Resource Group- Joint Base Lewis-McChesler represented by Deputy CISO Tracy Auldredge, Recruitment & Classification Specialist Rebel Supervisor Jason Tarver.

WaTech has a history of reaching out to the military community for IT talent. Our agency recruits service members and provide information about career opportunities and assist with expansion.

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[WaTech-WaTalk](#)

[see less](#)

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 Britton, Chris (WaTech) 4/3 4:26 PM

WaTech IT Industry Forum & AI Summit draws more than 250 IT leaders



More than 250 IT leaders from state agencies and leading technology companies attended a WaTech IT Industry Forum & AI Summit on March 25 to explore using artificial intelligence (AI) to improve government services and ensure the privacy of residents. Read the full story here: [WaTech IT Industry Forum & AI Summit draws more than 250 IT leaders](#)

[WaTech-WaTalk](#)

[see less](#)

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 Britton, Chris (WaTech) 3/28 9:21 AM Edited

Katy Ruckle speaks at Washington State IT Industry Forum & AI Summit



Washington State Chief Privacy Officer Katy Ruckle spoke at the State IT Industry Forum & AI Summit on March 25, where she discussed the role attendees play in navigating the potential applications of #AI.

Just recently, Katy and State Chief Technology Officer Nick Stowe appeared on TVW's Inside Olympia program to discuss how the state plans to handle the use of generative AI. [READ MORE](#)

[WaTech-WaTalk](#)

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Awards and recognition

Tavares Terry and Rhonda Mendel recognized for excelling above expectations during PSRW



DBI Director Tavares Terry and OCS Administrative Assistant Rhonda Mendel on Tuesday for excelling in their duties as public service employees. Governor Jay Insley congratulated and honored people who do such great work. Gov. Jay Insley said, "Rhonda! Read the full story on inSite."

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State Chief Privacy Officer Katy Ruckle honored as a Top 25 Doers, Dreamers, and Drivers of 2024



WaTech is excited to announce that Washington State's Chief Privacy Officer, Katy Ruckle, has been named one of the Top 25 Doers, Dreamers, and Drivers for 2024! Katy's groundbreaking work in AI safeguards is setting new standards in data protection. [READ MORE HERE](#)

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New @ WaTech: David Walker



David Walker: new network engineer, new Washington resident. David joined April 1. [READ MORE](#)

Employee Years of Service Milestones

Please help us congratulate these employees on reaching their milestones!

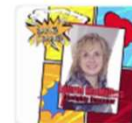


5 years	Brian Briggs - Senior Operations Support Engineer, NSD Andrew Johnson - Solutions Architect, NSD
10 years	Susannah Pitman - Senior GIS Architect, AID
25 years	Jerry Ferrante - Telephony Systems Administrator, NSD

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Administrative Professionals' Day

WaTech-WaTalk Today, we celebrate the superheroes of our office – our amazing Administrative Professionals! https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pvfK_nnz8co



Administrative Professionals' Day - YouTube

A video from Washington Technology Solutions on YouTube provided by: <https://www.youtube.com/>

www.youtube.com

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DEI-related content

Terry, Tavares (WaTech) 2/23 7:42 AM

Honoring Black History Month: African Americans and the Arts

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Faith Ringgold and Dindga McCannon



Faith Ringgold, *The American People Series #18: The Flag is Bleeding*, 1967, oil on canvas, 100 x 100 inches. Permanent Fund, 2021.28.1

Terry, Tavares (WaTech) 3/13 7:28 AM Edited

Celebrating Women's History Month

Did you know?

The Wyoming Territory was the first place in the U.S. to grant women the right to vote. The Wyoming Territorial legislature gave every woman the right to vote in 1890, making it the first country's first woman governor, Nellie Tayloe Ross, in 1924.



see more



Not All Women Gained the Vote in 1920 | A
For many women, the 19th Amendment was only the
beginning of a much longer fight.
www.pbs.org

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Terry, Tavares (WaTech) 4/22 7:44 AM

Office of Equity Save the Date: Equity and Belonging Community of Practice

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The Office of Equity would like to formally invite you to the Equity and Belonging Community of Practice (CoP) series. If you enjoy collaborating with like-minded individuals who are passionate about addressing systemic issues, advocating for policy changes, and implementing impactful initiatives to create a more inclusive and belonging environment, then this CoP series is for you!

Start date: May 15, 2024
From 11:00am – 12:30pm
Every third Wednesday of the month

Fun stuff

Gestewitz, Rob (WaTech) Thursday 9:30 AM Edited

New Employee

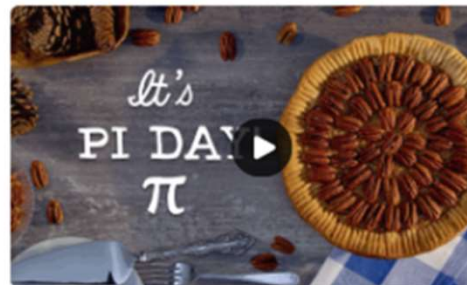
WaTech-WaTalk WaTech is excited to welcome the newest addition to our team.



Zebra-NewHire.mp4

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Pi Day quiz winners!



We have the results our Pi Day quiz, which closed yesterday, and the number of correct answers.

The winners are:

- **First place:** Keely Titus
- **Second place:** Kristin Chappell
- **Third place:** Lisa Kendall

Keely wins her choice of a sweet pie or savory pie (pizza); Kristin wins a pizza; Lisa wins a pizza.

Thanks to everyone who participated!!!

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BATTLE OF THE MEMES! (Thanksgiving)

Create your own meme about Thanksgiving

Here's how it works:

- Create a meme about Thanksgiving between now and Nov. 20
- Share it in this thread.
- We all vote for our favorite by reacting to it.
- The meme with the highest number of reactions wins. The lucky winner gets WaTech-WaTalk!

The winner will be announced Nov. 22. [Never created your own meme before? Here's how: How to Create Memes on Microsoft Word](#)

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Mark, Brian (WaTech) 11/13/23 12:52 PM



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November 14, 2023

Pulley, Sam (WaTech) 11/14/23 7:52 AM



CB Britton, Chris (WaTech) 4/8 9:03 AM

April 11 is National Pet Day!

Share a photo of your pet(s) with us



April 11 is National Pet day! If they have fur, scales, feathers (or something else), we want to see them! Share a photo of your favorite friend(s) with your fellow team members in honor of this day. (Don't forget to tell their names.)

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How we measure it

- Comments
- Reactions (likes, replies, emoticons, etc.)
- Posts



ENGAGEMENT

Also:

- Active vs inactive users

Since we started posting content more consistently in October 2023, we have seen:

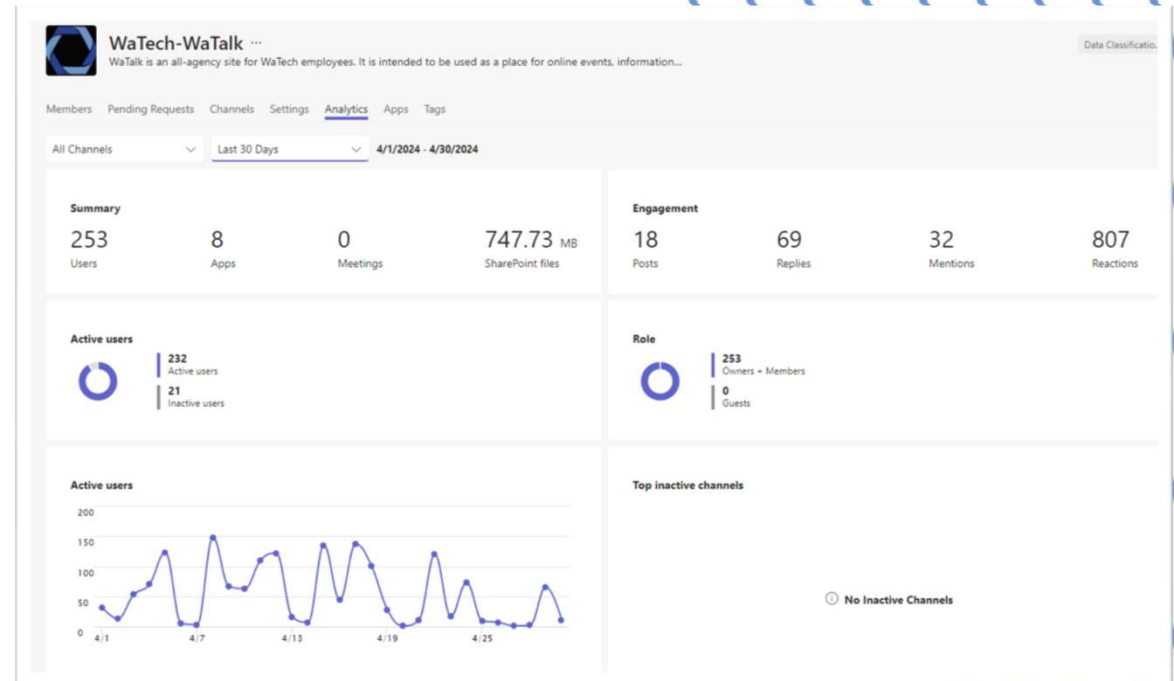
Engagement:

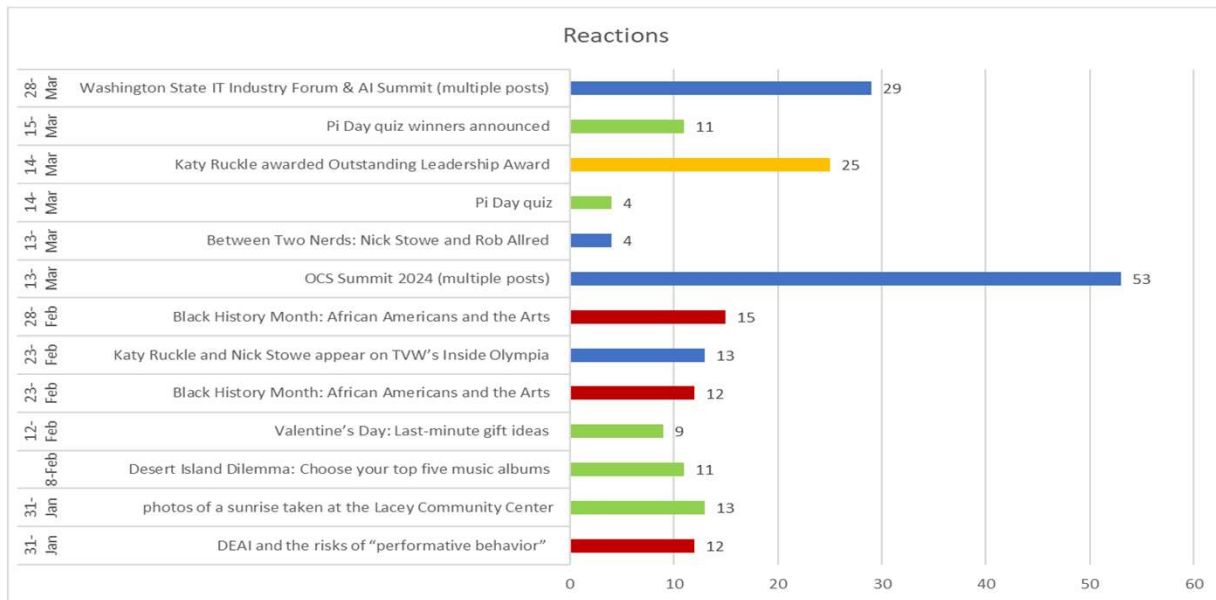
- Mentions increased from 2 to 46.
- Reactions increased from 211 to 316

Active vs inactive users:

- Active users increased from 119 to 236
- Inactive users decreased from 140 to 21
- 90% of our users are active

(Last 30 days of analytics as of 5-20-24)





LEGEND:

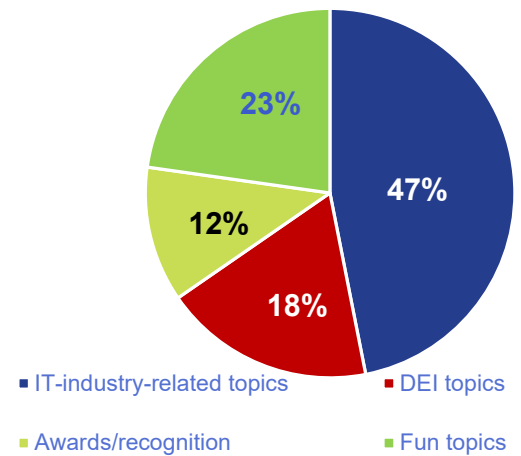
BLUE = topics related to IT-industry-related events

GREEN = fun topics, games or quizzes

ORANGE = topics related to awards or recognition

RED = DEI-related topics

Most popular topics (as measured by number of reactions)



Lessons learned

What worked

- Celebrate success (awards, recognitions, etc.)
- Pets, pets and more pets
- Meme contests
- Top-5 lists
- DEI-related content

Easy asks, easy tasks:

- Keep it simple—less is more

What doesn't work

Asking too much of your employees

- Long commitments
- Writing stories or anecdotes
- Overly complicated contests or scavenger hunts

Caveats

- Analytics are very limited, including reports.
- Data retention only goes back **90 days**.
 - If you forget to capture your data after that time, it's gone ...**forever**.
- Microsoft makes frequent updates to its products.

Questions/comments